ONE HERĂSTRĂU PLAZA

Why is this project a best practice?

Challenge

The project addresses the difficulty of scaling low-energy and healthy-building principles beyond a single dwelling. It had to combine density or phased delivery with reliable energy performance, good indoor conditions, landscape quality, mobility and construction cost, while keeping the sustainability measures practical for many future occupants.

Solution

The response combines two buildings connecting residents to nearby recreation, retail and daily services; a dense location near parks and lakes that supports active mobility and short trips; and Green Homes energy, materials and indoor-environment criteria integrated into a premium urban development. These measures were brought together through an integrated design approach and, where applicable, the Green Homes, nZEB or Passive House performance framework.

Replicability

The approach can be scaled through repeatable specifications for envelope, MEP systems, materials, commissioning, mobility and landscape. Replication is strongest when the developer applies the same measurable requirements to every phase and verifies them at handover, rather than treating certification as a one-off design exercise.

Key facts and figures

Location	Strada Zăgazului 21, Bucharest, Romania
Building use / function	Multi-family residential development with neighbourhood services

Project type (new build, refurbishment, extension)	New build
Plot area / Floor area	Approximately 13,230 m²; 147-156 apartments depending on source/phase
Year / phase	Completed / final certification reported in 2019
Climate zone	Temperate continental
Thematic focus / innovation	Integrated urban residence; access to parks, lakes and services; certified energy and indoor-quality measures
Investor / building owner	One United Properties
Architect	Not publicly disclosed in the consulted sources
Other involved stakeholders	Romania Green Building Council; retail/service partners; MEP and landscape teams
Contact person	One United Properties - https://www.one.ro/
Further information	https://green-homes.org/property/one-herastrau-plaza/ https://www.rogbc.org/proiecte-certificate-rogbc?lang=en https://www.rogbc.org/_files/ugd/40ee3e_b5d91d7a3b71422cb98cd7a289b89c79.pdf

One Herăstrău Plaza is a new build project in Strada Zăgazului 21, Bucharest, Romania. It functions as multi-family residential development with neighbourhood services. Its main best-practice contribution is Treats location and access to services as part of residential sustainability, not only building technology. The documented strategy brings together two buildings connecting residents to nearby recreation, retail and daily services, a dense location near parks and lakes that supports active mobility and short trips, and Green Homes energy, materials and indoor-environment criteria integrated into a premium urban development. Public sources list 147 or 156 apartments; the difference appears to reflect phase or counting scope. Public-source research was reviewed in July 2026; data that vary by phase are explicitly flagged in this sheet.

What was done differently?

1. Performance concept - Two buildings connecting residents to nearby recreation, retail and daily services.
2. Integrated systems and operation - A dense location near parks and lakes that supports active mobility and short trips.
3. Wider value - Green homes energy, materials and indoor-environment criteria integrated into a premium urban development.

What was achieved?

Impact

Environmental impact: The project reduces energy and associated emissions primarily by lowering demand and then using efficient or renewable systems. Its material, landscape, waste or mobility measures add benefits beyond operational energy where documented. A verified whole-life carbon assessment was not publicly available, so the impact is described qualitatively unless a source provides a specific figure.

Economic impact: Lower energy demand can reduce utility exposure and improve long-term operating-cost predictability. Standardised high-performance specifications and third-party certification can also support quality assurance, market value and access to green-finance products. Public sources do not provide a complete investment, payback or life-cycle-cost analysis for this project.

Social impact: The main social benefits are stable indoor temperatures, better air quality, daylight and acoustic comfort, together with safer and more attractive shared or outdoor spaces where these form part of the project. The project also raises market awareness by making high-performance housing visible to residents, designers, contractors and investors.

Key Learnings

Success factors: Key success factors are an integrated design process, a clear performance framework, early coordination of envelope and building services, selection of competent suppliers, quality control during construction and commissioning. Transparent documentation and communication with occupants are essential to preserve the intended performance in use.

Lessons for replication: Replication should start with an energy and comfort target, not a catalogue of technologies. Design teams should verify thermal bridges, airtightness, ventilation, controls and renewable sizing together; record assumptions by project phase; commission systems; and monitor early operation. Where public figures differ by phase, the final as-built dataset must become the single source of truth.